

# RITESH NAIK

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**National Recognition:** National Award: PLUTO won the Indian Staffing Federation's Staffing Excellence Recognition 2026 for Outstanding Initiative — one of 18 initiatives recognised across ISF's 120+ member companies; awarded on stage at ISF's 18th National Employment Conference, New Delhi (Aug 2026), and featured in ISF's "Recognising Initiatives of the Staffing Industry" book.

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI Product Manager with 11 years across engineering, entrepreneurship, and product — nearly 7 of them in product, including ~3 as a founder. Nearly 4 years building and owning 5 production AI products in HRTech — from RAG-based assistants and resume evaluators to a voice-screening bot and an internal ATS — deployed to 150+ users with measurable gains in speed (80–90%), quality (shortlist rate +40%), and cost efficiency. Builds hands-on: with no dedicated engineering team, prototypes and ships production AI personally (Python, LLM APIs, RAG). Former founder (PocketTrucks — seed-funded logistics marketplace, 190+ drivers; owned roadmap and specs with an outsourced dev team). Winner of the Indian Staffing Federation's Staffing Excellence Recognition 2026 (Outstanding Initiative) for PLUTO — one of 18 initiatives recognised across ISF's 120+ member companies.

## CORE SKILLS

**AI / ML:** Generative AI, RAG Architectures, LLMs (Gemini, Groq, GPT), Pinecone, Prompt Engineering, LangChain, HuggingFace, Multi-Agent Systems

**Product:** AI Product Strategy, OKRs, Roadmapping, Discovery, Prioritisation (RICE/ICE), Agile/Sprint Planning, 0→1 & Scaling

**Technical:** Python, SQL, REST APIs, Flask, Make.com (Integromat), VAPI, Cursor, VSCode, Git, Postman

**Platforms:** Oorwin, Ceipal, Zoho CRM/Analytics, Google Analytics, Power BI, Looker Studio, Naukri, ATS/CRM integrations

**Leadership:** IT function ownership (direct report), cross-functional leadership across marketing & operations, stakeholder management, GTM, Enterprise SaaS

## EXPERIENCE

**Product Manager – AI & Automation** | **PeopleLogic Business Solutions** | Oct 2022 – Present

*Own the AI product portfolio end-to-end with the IT function reporting directly; partner cross-functionally with marketing and operations to drive AI strategy for 150+ recruiters across India and global teams. No dedicated engineering team — I prototype, build and ship these products hands-on.*

- PLUTO AI Recruit Suite — built an end-to-end AI recruiter toolkit (JD Handbook Generator + Resume Evaluator + Voice Bot) that compressed JD analysis from 15–20 min to under 2 min, resume evaluation from 5–10 min to under 2 min, and lifted client shortlist rate from 50% to 70%; cost per evaluation optimised from ₹4 to ₹0.57 (85% reduction) at 30,000 evaluations/month.
- PLUTO won the Indian Staffing Federation's Staffing Excellence Recognition 2026 (Outstanding Initiative) — one of 18 initiatives recognised across ISF's 120+ member companies; profiled as Initiative No. 10 in ISF's "Recognising Initiatives of the Staffing Industry" publication.
- HR RAG Bot — enterprise HR policy assistant on Groq + Pinecone (hybrid BM25 + vector search) that cut policy lookup time by 90% and achieved 95% user satisfaction across 50+ policy documents.
- VAPI Voice Bot — piloted AI call screening for L1 interviews, offloading 25% of recruiter screening workload and capturing structured candidate data for model retraining.
- SpringBoard Analytics Platform — API-integrated dashboard connecting ATS (Oorwin/Ceipal), job portals (Naukri), and call systems (VoxPro); eliminated 80% of manual monthly reporting overhead and delivered real-time KPI visibility organisation-wide.
- IRIS — built a ground-up internal ATS to manage PeopleLogic's own hiring pipeline, reducing dependency on external tools and standardising internal recruitment workflows.
- Recruitment Infrastructure — migrated 150+ users from Excel to enterprise ATS/CRM (Oorwin, Ceipal, Zoho); designed system architecture, configured automations, integrated portals, and built unified analytics via Make.com and Zoho Analytics (Deluge scripting); increased recruiter productivity by 30% and reduced lead-to-hire cycle time by 20%.

**Business Development Specialist** | **Open Financial Technologies** | Nov 2020 – Sep 2022

- Customer-facing liaison for B2B fintech platform — collected user feedback that directly shaped product improvements and pricing strategy.
- Identified critical UX friction points in onboarding; product team implemented streamlined signup flow based on findings.

- Delivered competitive intelligence and pricing recommendations (feature tiering) to improve conversion and upsell rates.
- Created sales enablement materials and conducted product demos driving enterprise customer adoption.

#### Co-Founder | **PocketTrucks Services Pvt Ltd** | Feb 2018 – Oct 2020

- Built and launched India's first real-time truck booking marketplace from 0→1; onboarded 190+ drivers within 60 days and secured ₹10L seed funding.
- Specified real-time booking and dispatch automation via REST APIs, replacing manual phone-based dispatch.
- Owned the product roadmap, specs and feature logic with an outsourced development team; ran the driver and shipper feedback loop directly.

#### Procurement Engineer | **LKQ India Pvt Ltd** | Jul 2016 – Jan 2018

- Designed analytics-powered sourcing workflows that increased procurement productivity by 70% across automotive aftermarket SKUs.

#### Graduate Apprentice Trainee | **Volvo Buses India Pvt Ltd** | Dec 2014 – Nov 2015

- Contributed to new product development for BRT and SLF bus prototypes for the Indian market.

### FLAGSHIP PROJECTS

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#### ▶ **PLUTO AI Recruit Suite** — *Lead Product Manager — Discovery to Production*

- JD Handbook Generator: transforms any JD into boolean strings, ideal candidate profiles, interview questions, and hiring strategy in under 2 min (down from 15–20 min).
- Resume Evaluator: LLM-powered scoring with explainability, job-hopping analysis, skills gap, and recommendation — under 2 min per eval, 85% cost reduction (₹4→₹0.57), 70% shortlist rate.
- Voice Screening Bot (VAPI): AI-led L1 interviews offloading 25% of manual screening; structured outputs fed back as model retraining signals.

#### ▶ **HR RAG Bot** — *Lead PM — Architecture & Launch*

- Enterprise HR policy assistant using hybrid search (BM25 + vector) over Pinecone + Groq; 90% lookup time reduction, 95% CSAT, 50+ documents indexed.

#### ▶ **SpringBoard Analytics Platform** — *Product Owner — E2E*

- API-driven internal analytics platform integrating ATS, job portals, and call systems; eliminated 80% of manual reporting overhead; adopted organisation-wide.

#### ▶ **IRIS — Internal ATS** — *Product Owner — 0→1*

- Custom internal applicant tracking system built from scratch to manage PeopleLogic's own hiring pipeline; eliminated reliance on external ATS for internal roles.

#### ▶ **PocketTrucks Marketplace** — *Co-Founder & Product Lead*

- 0→1 logistics marketplace with real-time bidding, live tracking, and trust-based feedback loops; 190+ drivers, ₹10L seed funding, 80% fleet utilisation in 60 days.

### TECHNICAL TOOLBOX

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**Languages:** Python, SQL

**AI / ML:** Groq (Qwen 3 32B), Gemini 2.5 Flash, GPT-4, Pinecone, HuggingFace, LangChain, RAG pipelines, Prompt Engineering, AI agents (Hugging Face AI Agents Fundamentals, certified)

**Platforms:** Oorwin, Ceipal, Zoho CRM, Make (Integromat), VAPI, Google Analytics, Google Colab

**Tools:** Cursor, VSCode, Git, Postman, Antigravity

**Practices:** Agile, OKRs, ICE/RICE prioritisation, AARRR funnel, A/B testing, Sprint Planning, Backlog Grooming

### RECOGNITION & IMPACT

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★ 🏆 **PLUTO** won the Indian Staffing Federation's Staffing Excellence Recognition 2026 — Outstanding Initiative; one of 18 initiatives recognised across ISF's 120+ member companies, awarded on stage at ISF's 18th National Employment Conference, New Delhi (Aug 2026), and profiled in ISF's "Recognising Initiatives of the Staffing Industry" book.

★ Scaled AI productivity suite across 150+ recruiters — shortlist quality +40% (50%→70%), JD analysis time -90%, eval cost -85%.

★ Voice bot pilot offloaded 25% of recruiter screening workload; HR RAG Bot achieved 95% user satisfaction at enterprise scale.

★ Hugging Face — AI Agents Fundamentals, certified (March 2026).

## EDUCATION

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**B.E (Bachelor of Engineering) — Mechanical Engineering** | MITK | 2010–2014